

Harbor handoff study

1. Purpose

This synthetic study compares two inspection routes over six weekday trials.
The observations describe this sample only; weather and staffing were held constant.

2. Findings

Table 1 records median elapsed time and the number of missed handoffs.

Route	Median (min)	Missed handoffs
Check first	12	1
Test first	19	3

The check-first route was faster by 7 minutes, but this is not a causal estimate.



Figure 1. Gate order: check, test, then release; each gate must pass before the next.

3. Limits

The trial excluded overnight operations and must not be generalized to storms.

4. References

[1] Harbor Lab. Handoff protocol, synthetic edition, 2026, sections 2-3.

[2] Harbor Lab. Trial log, synthetic edition, 2026, entries 1-6.

Appendix A. Observation rule

A missed handoff means a parcel waited more than 5 minutes after its release signal.

Observers recorded one timestamp per gate and did not change the route mid-trial.